



Judge rejects Musk's demand

A US judge rejected Elon Musk's demand from Twitter to hand over data for 200 million user accounts. <https://digit.in/sep22-31>



No sensitive Insta content

Instagram has announced that it will limit sensitive content for new teen users by default. <https://digit.in/sep22-32>



Who doesn't know her?

who prefer watching the viral videos or enjoying their favourite playlists on the go. With ear plugs in place, they remain connected to the virtual space 24X7 via mobile phones and tablets, partially losing touch with the reality. The pragmatic world is too complex and stressful for them. Therefore, while commuting or managing their academic assignments, they click on music links to shut all worries out.

"Music is indispensable to me. Whether am suffering insomnia or feeling low, heart-warming ballads, relaxing strains and lilting melodies work wonders for me. It rejuvenates me and acts as a great mood lifter. So, depending on the mental make-up I'm wearing at a given time, my choices vary," shares middle-aged homemaker Alkananda Rawal in between her household chores.

Banker Adil Perwez takes his nightdrive quite seriously while returning home from his workstation. "I turn to my Android phone's webpage of Lo-fi stocks and let the music flow at ease, seeping through my senses. This is my daily detox routine after a long hard day with money matters and number crunching," he reveals.

Melancholy, dejection, romance, heartaches, lovelorn status, pensiveness... for every emotion, get a taste of this useful Lo-fi medicine. "It could be equivalent to a pep talk or

Catharsis, transporting your senses to a peaceful haven or submerging you into a sea of tranquility," opines a psychologist. "Log in to house music for a foot-tapping tempo or those mushy mashups for that desirable analgesic impact," is the pat remark of a keen YouTuber.



Never gets old

REPEAT VALUE

Remakes and remixes rehashed with *jbankaar* beats have been doing the rounds of Bollywood music scene for years now. From an elite aficionado's abode in high-rises to the humble layman down on the streets — also labeled as the lowest common denominator — all have been exposed to the pulsating beats interspersed with rap and English lyrics as well as Hindi-Urdu *shayari*, fast-paced rhythmic patterns, itemized songs, *et al* over decades. Some even shook a leg to these chartbusters as party animals with throbbing DJ music under the psychedelic lights at discs, while others heard the same in a local shop on speakers. Interestingly, at a crucial

juncture of experimental music world-wide, when the millennium is still young at heart and is yet to touch a quarter of the century, lo-fi marches in with flying colours. It stokes the repeat value of widely lapped-up songs through the art of repackaging.

WIDGET-FRIENDLY TAKERS

"Today's music junkies are tech-savvy and gadget freaks. They are app-friendly and more inclined to pictorial representations. Until recently, a compilation would be played either with the lyrics or film visuals. Now with the advent of lo-fi, images are lent a Prisma effect, which is a photo editing app. This certainly lets your imagination run riot as animated pictures invariably grab eyeballs," opines graphic artiste Jignesh Dave.

Music has no boundaries. It is always in a flux. A gamut of diverse genres replenishes the musical realm. "Trends will come and go but explorations will continue," observes sound recordist and audio engineer Ajay Pawar of Delhi-based Sonic Field Studios.

"I've been working on lo-fi style for the past couple of years. I can manufacture this musical type with a mélange of low frequency, thumping beats, pitter-patter of the rain, a smattering of foreign wordings and other add-ons," he assures with confidence. After a pause, he further informs: "Lo-fi will soon be replaced by its cousin with a dash of hip-hop and also the R&B (rhythm and blues) genre with the same effect. Like in the United States, mumble rap was already famous, which gained momentum in India much later. So, within 2023, we can expect more musical inventions. Even house music is being rejuvenated."

As independent artistes refuse to get straitjacketed by any conventional method or norm, they naturally look forward to offbeat genres and formats to experiment at free will with whatever catches their fancy. "Bollywood caters to popular tastes and the public